



India Responds

## ASK NOW

India is dogged by a lack of clarity in its preparedness and response to the nefarious designs of terrorists. The War on Terror needs that definition of purpose and specific goals. INDIA TODAY's panel of experts addresses that need, answering reader's queries and offering solutions.



**LALIT MANSINGH**  
Former foreign secretary

**Why is India not taking steps to destroy terror camps in Pakistan and Bangladesh?**

JOTHISH, ([jothish\\_kumar@hotmail.com](mailto:jothish_kumar@hotmail.com))  
First, there is no sanction under the international law for attacking another country. Second, the training camps are mainly make-shift facilities, which can be relocated. Third, there is danger of military strikes resulting in collateral damage, i.e. innocent civilians getting killed. Finally, a military strike may result in Pakistan using nuclear weapons.



**B. RAMAN**  
Former additional secretary R&AW

**Why do you advocate reviving R&AW and bleeding Pakistan rather than military action against LeT and terror camps?**

VIJAY, ([VijayBee@gmail.com](mailto:VijayBee@gmail.com))  
I advocate covert action to make Pakistan realise that its policy of terrorism as a strategic weapon will not pay. We must have a mix of incentives and disincentives: incentives by improving bilateral relations and disincentives by way of covert actions. Direct strikes may not pay as the US has learnt in Afghanistan and FATA.



**KAPIL KAK**  
Retired air marshal and joint director, Centre for Air Power Studies

**Can't the government make policies to check activities of religious institutions and influx of money from foreign lands?**

ARUN, ([arun\\_hegde24@yahoo.co.in](mailto:arun_hegde24@yahoo.co.in))  
You are right in expressing the apprehension that foreign funding is the source of a bulk of religious-extremist-driven terrorism. Interdiction of foreign funds for extremist religious activities and the terrorism these breed, especially from Saudi Arabia etc, should be a focused and time-bound effort at the global, regional and national levels.



**GURMEET KANWAL**  
Retired brigadier and director of Centre for Land Warfare Studies

**Which is better—war against Pakistan or war against terror?**

VINU, ([vinu\\_sasidharan@yahoo.co.in](mailto:vinu_sasidharan@yahoo.co.in))  
Declaring war on Pakistan will only add to the complexity of the problem—as Pakistan is a nuclear-armed state. Overt military measures and covert intelligence operations must be considered to raise the cost for the Pakistan Army and the ISI as they pursue their “low risk, high pay-off” venture to destabilise India.

Ask your questions and get their answers now.  
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## India's Views

Why has Ajmal been kept alive? Is our government waiting for a plane hijack so that terrorists can seek his release. We need to take him to the Taj Mahal Hotel area and hang him till death.

RANJEET, Thane

**For the foolproof security of Indians, we should have national identity cards. If we wish to stop drug peddling by the citizens of our neighbouring countries, we need to secure ourselves from all corners.**

RAJBIR SINGH, Bampton

All TV channels that were competing with each other by giving minute details of NSG movement and terrorists in Mumbai should tender an apology for helping the terrorists and their guides in Pakistan. Leaders from across the world must debate on the causes and remedies of terrorism.

MUNI MAHAJAN, Chandigarh

According to the FBI, terrorists will soon be equipped with nuclear weapons. It seems that on that day too, India will be looking at the US to conduct strikes against terrorists in Pakistan even after losing so many innocent lives.

SID, Jaipur

**Start training counter-insurgency groups, who can fight terror. Highly motivated Indians need to be trained within the next three months with a specific mission to strike where it hurts. Rules be damned.**

VASUDEVAN SREENIVASAN, Madurai

I feel it is more important to deal with the enemy within than deal with the enemy on foreign soil. A good example of this is Union Minorities Affairs Minister A.R. Antulay. He has given an irresponsible public statement with the only intention of supporting Pakistan. Our ruling party is more worried about votes from minorities than the security and pride of our nation.

ROMEEO, Delhi